

HP Veer to launch in May

The 2.2-inch smartphone Veer from HP sporting the webOS 2.2 is expected to launch on May 2

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Head here for an in-depth review on ASUS E35M1-I Deluxe board

Bazaar

Dell Venue Pro

A second sighting

This is only the second WP7 phone that we've reviewed, the HTC HD 7 being the first. The Venue Pro is a large, heavy (192 grams) phone, and feels thicker owing to a concave display. The screen is touted as gorilla glass, but picked up scratches. The top and bottom of the phone are wedge-shaped and with the chrome-rimmed 3.5mm jack adds some style. The bottom slideout QWERTY is about the sexiest form factor ever, and the mechanism is quite slick. The battery cover is glossy, a shame since we loved the matte one on the Dell Venue.

We're not going to get into the benefits and pitfalls of WP7, for they alone could span several

pages, but for normal consumer (as opposed to corporates), the Venue Pro has a few serious limitations – Bluetooth transfers, OS X connectivity to name a couple. We also had issues pairing with a couple of Bluetooth headsets that were on hand. Then there were Venue Pro-specific issues – like our test SIM getting locked without a password or the Internet refusing to work after disabling and re-enabling data connections – an issue that a restart finally resolved. The display is advertised as AMOLED, and while the blackness level is good, and the colours are better



than the Dell Venue, we still find the contrast slightly lacking. Sunlight legibility remains poor. The QWERTY keypad is a plus. The touchscreen is very sensitive, and the on-screen keypad works flawlessly. The Venue Pro is a reasonably speedy phone and we faced no slowdowns despite the fact that it runs a somewhat ageing SoC (Qualcomm QSD8250).

The Venue Pro is a good attempt from Dell, especially given their relatively short time in market with smartphones, and if you're looking for a WP7 device with a good QWERTY, this is a viable option.

Michael Browne

Specifications

Display: 4.1-inches, 480 x 800 pixels; OS: Windows Phone 7; SoC: Qualcomm QSD8250; RAM: 512 MB; inbuilt storage: 8 GB, micro SD expandable; battery: 1400 mAh; weight: 192.8 grams

Contact

Dell India

Phone: 1800-425-4026

Web site: www.dell.co.in

Price: ₹34,990 (MRP, 8 GB)

7.0/10

Features.....	7.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	7.0
Value for money.....	6.0

Specifications

Processor: AMD E350;
Graphics: Radeon HD6310;
RAM: upto 8 GB DDR3;
Integrated WiFi Present

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: 18002090365

Email: reachus@asus.com

Web site: www.asus.in

Price: ₹10,750

7.0/10

Features.....	8.5
Performance.....	6.5
Build.....	7.0
Value for money.....	5.5

ASUS E35M1-I Deluxe

Feature-rich option for an HTPC setup

After testing the Gigabyte GA E350N a month back, it was interesting to get our hands on ASUS's E35M1-I Deluxe board this time around. It has two interesting additions over the GA E350N in the form of an internal 802.11n WiFi adapter and a bluetooth 3.0 adapter on the back I/O panel.

A major portion of the board is covered by a passive heatsink which has numerous fins for faster cooling. Although we did find the temperatures rising to about 60 degrees. The Turbo Key II jumper setting allows easy overclocking, although we

don't really see a major performance difference on such a low end APU.

Performance-wise it gave an overall PC Mark Vantage score of 2553 (slightly higher than GA E350N) and Cinebench R10 rendering was at par with GA E350N. Most of the real world tests like DivX encoding, WinRAR compression gave the same scores. File transfer was faster on the ASUS board.

Gaming, using only the AMD HD 6310 graphics solution will give playable frame rates only on lowering the resolutions. Company Of Heroes : Tales of Valor gave 50 fps at 1024x768, Low setting. For decent gaming, you will



need an external graphics card. HD playback was flawless and we did not notice any stutter or skipping.

At ₹10,750 it is priced higher than the Gigabyte E350N, but it does sport some additional features like integrated WiFi adapter, a PCIe x16 slot and a bluetooth adapter. Product comes recommended around the ₹8,000 price point.

Nimish Sawant